

The Carpenter's Lantern

In a small town nestled between mountains and rivers, there lived a carpenter named Jonah. He was known for his skill with wood, but even more for his kindness. Jonah believed deeply in the teachings of Jesus, especially the call to love one's neighbor.

One evening, a terrible fire broke out in the village. Families rushed to save what they could, but the smoke was thick and the night was dark. Jonah, instead of fleeing, ran to his workshop. He grabbed the lantern he had built years ago—a sturdy lamp carved with a cross on its side—and lifted it high.

With the lantern's light, Jonah guided frightened families through the smoke to safety. He carried children in his arms, comforted the elderly, and refused to rest until everyone was safe. His hands were burned, his clothes torn, but his spirit never wavered.

When the fire was finally out, the villagers gathered around Jonah. They saw not just a carpenter, but a man who had lived out the words of Christ: "You are the light of the world. A city set on a hill cannot be hidden."

From that day forward, Jonah's lantern was placed in the town square. It became a symbol of faith and courage, reminding everyone that true Christianity is not only about belief, but about shining light in the darkest moments.

Years later, children would ask their parents about the old lantern. And the parents would tell the story of Jonah, the carpenter who showed them that love, sacrifice, and faith can turn even the smallest flame into a beacon of hope.